RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization con cerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO resolution A.886(21) on Procedure for the adoption of, and amendments to, performance standards and technical specificatio ns, by which the Assembly resolved that the function of adopting performance standards a nd technical specifications, as well as amendments thereto, shall be performed by the Ma ritime Safety Committee, on behalf of the Organization, RECALLING FURTHER resolution A.1 045(27) on Pilot transfer arrangements , which was amended by resolution A.1108(29), NOT ING resolution MSC.572(110) by which it adopted amendments to regulation V/23 of the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCR esolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf amended by resolution A.1108(29), NOTING resolution MSC.572(110) by which it adopted amendments to regulation V/23 of the International Convention f or the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974 ("the Convention") to make the performance standards on pilot transfer arrangements mandatory under the Convention, RECOGNIZING that the resp onsibility for safe practices for the transfer of pilots and other personnel rests with each person involved in the activity including the shipowner, operator, master and crew, pilotage provider, pilot and pilot boat crew, as well as the person being transferred, H AVING CONSIDERED, at its 110th session, the recommendation made by the Sub-Committee on Navigation, Communications and Search and Rescue at its eleventh session, 1 ADOPTS the P erformance standards for pilot transfer arrangements , set out in the annex to the prese nt resolution; 2 INVITES Contracting Governments to the Convention to note that the Perf ormance --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOReso lutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf annex to the present resolution; 2 INVITES Contr acting Governments to the Convention to note that the Performance standards for pilot tr ansfer arrangements will take effect on 1 January 2028 upon entry into force of the amen dments to regulation V/23 of the Convention adopted by resolution MSC.572(110); 3 NOTES that, under the provisions of regulation V/23 of the Convention, amendments to the Perfo rmance standards for pilot transfer arrangements shall be adopted, brought into force an d take effect in accordance with the provisions of article VIII of the Convention concer ning the amendment procedure applicable to the annex to the Convention other than chapte r I; 4 REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit certified copies of this resolution an d the text of the Performance standards for pilot transfer arrangements contained in the annex to all Contracting Governments to the Convention; 5 ALSO REQUESTS the Secretary-Ge neral to transmit copies of this resolution and the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/loca lresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf to a ll Contracting Governments to the Convention; 5 ALSO REQUESTS the Secretary-General to t ransmit copies of this resolution and the annex to all Members of the Organization which are not Contracting Governments to the Convention; 6 INVITES Governments to encourage th e development of novel technologies aimed at improving the safety of pilot transfer arra ngements and to keep the Organization advised of any positive results; 7 URGES all parti es concerned to observe both the spirit and intent of these performance standards, to en sure safety is not compromised; 8 INVITES the Assembly to revoke resolutions A.1045(27) and A.1108(29) as of 1 April 2030, and endorse the action taken by the Maritime Safety C ommittee.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF ER ARRANGEMENTS - 2 - ANNEX PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS INTROD UCTION 1 Purpose --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Index ofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf - 2 - ANNEX PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR P ILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS INTRODUCTION 1 Purpose These performance standards provide fo r requirements for the design, manufacture, construction, rigging, installation of pilot ladder winch reels, operational readiness, onboard inspection and maintenance, familiari zation and approval in relation to pilot transfer arrangements required under regulation V/23 of the 1974 SOLAS Convention, adopted by resolution MSC.572(110).

2 Definitions For the purpose of these performance standards, the following definitions apply: .1 Pilot transfer arrangements refers to all equipment and arrangements used sole ly for the embarkation and disembarkation of pilots and other personnel, including pilot ladders, accommodation ladders, embarkation platforms, manropes, pilot ladder winch reel s, securing arrangements and other associated equipment.

.2 Point of access means the location at which pilots or other personnel transfer --- UR L: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCRes olutions/MSC.576(110).pdf associated equipment.

.2 Point of access means the location at which pilots or other personnel transfer betwee

n a pilot ladder or accommodation ladder and the deck or side opening of a ship.

.3 Manropes means ropes hung on either side of a pilot ladder for assistance in ascendin g and descending.

.4 Trapdoor means an aperture with a cover located in a platform allowing the pilot ladd er and manropes to pass through without obstruction or distortion and used by pilots or other personnel to transfer between the pilot ladder and the accommodation ladder.

.5 Securing a pilot ladder at intermediate length means securing a pilot ladder at a poi nt other than the thimble ends.

3 General 3.1 Pilot transfer arrangements shall be designed, installed, inspected, maint ained and rigged to enable pilots and other personnel to embark and disembark safely in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf rigged to enable pilots and other personnel to embark an d disembark safely in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim.

3.2 The height of climb on a pilot ladder shall not be less than 1.5 m and not more than 9 m from the surface of the water to the point of access in all seagoing conditions of d raught and trim.

Whenever the height of climb on a pilot ladder from the surface of the water to the poin t of access exceeds 9 m, the ship shall be provided with and rig an accommodation ladder in conjunction with the pilot ladder (i.e.

a combination arrangement).

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF ER ARRANGEMENTS - 3 - 3.3 Where the height of climb is less than 1.5 m from the surface of the water and a pilot ladder is not used as part of a pilot transfer arrangement, thi s does not exempt any vessel or personnel involved in the transfer from ensuring that th e transfer is completed safely, is --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Kno wledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf personnel involved in the transfer from ensuring that the transfer is completed safely, is adequately risk ass essed and any equipment other than a pilot ladder is used in accordance with these perfo rmance standards.

3.4 Pilot transfer arrangements shall be provided to enable pilots and other personnel t o embark and disembark safely on either side of the ship.

Necessary equipment shall be carried on each side unless the equipment is capable of bei ng transferred for use on either side.

3.5 Pilot ladders and manropes used for the transfer of pilots and other personnel shall be clearly identified with permanent marking so as to enable identification of each appl iance for the purposes of survey, inspection and record-keeping.

3.6 Reference in these performance standards to an accommodation ladder includes a slopi ng ladder used as part of the pilot transfer arrangements.

3.7 The onboard inspection and rigging of the pilot transfer arrangements and the --- UR L: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCRes olutions/MSC.576(110).pdf sloping ladder used as part of the pilot transfer arrangements .

3.7 The onboard inspection and rigging of the pilot transfer arrangements and the embark ation and disembarkation of pilots and other personnel shall be supervised by a designat ed responsible officer.

During the transfer of pilots or other personnel, the responsible officer shall have mea ns of communication with the navigation bridge and shall arrange for the escort of the p ilot by a safe route to and from the navigation bridge and other personnel to an appropr iate safe location.

PART A – DESIGN, MANUFACTURE AND CONSTRUCTION 4 Pilot ladders 4.1 The steps of the pilot ladders shall comply with the following requirements: .1 if made of hardwood, they shall be made in one piece, free of any knots.

Wood shall not be treated or coated with paint, varnish or other coatings; .2 if made of material other than hardwood, they shall be made from resilient --- URL: https://wwwcdn. imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(1 10).pdf .2 if made of material other than hardwood, they shall be made from resilient pl astic or rubber of equivalent strength, stiffness and durability; .3 they shall have an

efficient non-slip surface; .4 they shall be long enough to accommodate a distance betwe
en the inner surface of the side ropes of not less than 400 mm, and shall be not less th
an 115 mm in width and 25 mm in thickness, excluding any non-slip device or grooving; .5
they shall be equally spaced not less than 310 mm and not more than 350 mm apart measure
d from the top of each step or spreader step; .6 they shall be secured in such a manner
that each will remain horizontal; and .7 the four lowest steps shall be of rubber of suf
ficient strength and stiffness or other equivalent material.

4.2 Pilot ladders with more than five steps shall have spreader steps complying with par
agraph 4.1 and each spreader step shall be not less than 1.8 m in length.

The lowest --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOR
esolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf paragraph 4.1 and each spreader step shall be
not less than 1.8 m in length.

The lowest spreader step shall be the fifth step from the bottom of the ladder and addit
ional spreader steps shall be provided at such intervals as will prevent the pilot ladde
r from twisting, conforming to standards acceptable to the Organization.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF
ER ARRANGEMENTS - 4 - 4.3 Permanent measuring marking shall be provided at a regular int
erval of every three steps, approximately every 1 m, throughout the length of the pilot
ladder consistent with ladder design, use and maintenance in order to facilitate the rig
ging of the ladder to the required height.

4.4 Pilot ladders shall be permanently marked by the manufacturer with at least the foll
owing information on the underside of the uppermost step and the lowermost spreader step
: .1 the name of the manufacturer; --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Kno
wledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf following information
on the underside of the uppermost step and the lowermost spreader step: .1 the name of t
he manufacturer; .2 an equipment serial number or other means of unique identification w
hich the manufacturer shall be able to validate; .3 date of manufacture; and .4 name and
details of the approving authority.

4.5 Pilot ladders shall be of a single length capable of reaching the surface of the wat
er from the point of access or, where a combination arrangement is used, from the platfo
rm of the combination arrangement, in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim a nd t
he specific condition of an adverse list of 15° in the lightest seagoing condition.

4.6 The side ropes on each side of the pilot ladder shall consist of a double length of
uncovered rope not less than 20 mm and not more than 22 mm in diameter.

The double length shall be made from a continuous length of rope with no joints having a
breaking strength of at --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentr
e/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf shall be made from a continuous
length of rope with no joints having a breaking strength of at least 24 kN.

The midpoint of the double length shall be located on a thimble.

The ends of each of the side ropes shall be properly finished.2F 4.7 Each of the side ro
pe s shall be mildew -resistant manila rope 3For other material of equivalent strength,
durability, elongation characteristics and grip which has been protected against actinic
degradation.

4.8 Each of the side ropes shall be secured together both above and below each step with
an arrangement properly designed for this purpose.

Where a seizing method4Fwith step fixtures, such as chocks or wedges, is used, it shall
hold each step horizontal in all planes at all times.

Where a mechanical clamping device is used to secure each of the side ropes together, it
shall grip each of the side ropes in the pair independently and with the same grip force
.

Any surface --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMO
Resolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf grip each of the side ropes in the pair inde
pendently and with the same grip force.

Any surface of a mechanical clamping device that pilots or other personnel may handle sh
all be suitable to be grasped by bare hands.

The use of cable ties, u -clamps or worm driven clips as a means of securing steps is pr
ohibited.

5 Combination arrangements 5.1 The length of the accommodation ladder shall be sufficien
t to ensure that its angle of slope does not exceed 45°.

In ships with large draught ranges, several pilot ladder hanging positions shall be prov
ided, resulting in lesser angles of slope.

The accommodation ladder shall be at least 600 mm in width.

The accommodation ladder hoisting and lowering mechanism shall include protection that e
nsures the mechanism cannot be inadvertently operated during the transfer of pilots and
other personnel.

5.2 Intermediate platforms, if fitted, shall be self -levelling.

Treads and steps of the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentr
e/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf 5.2 Intermediate platforms, if f
itted, shall be self -levelling.

Treads and steps of the accommodation ladder shall be so designed that an adequate and s
afe anti -skid foothold is provided at the operative angles.

5.3 The accommodation ladder and platform shall be equipped on both sides with stanchion
s and rigid handrails, but if hand ropes are used, they shall be tight and properly RESO
LUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER A
RRANGEMENTS - 5 - secured.

The vertical space between the handrail or hand rope and the stringers of the ladder sha
ll be securely fenced.

5.4 Accommodation ladders, together with any suspension arrangements or attachments fitt
ed and intended for use in accordance with these performance standards, shall meet the r
equirements for the means of embarkation on and disembarkation from ships as required by
regulation II-1/3-9.

5.5 In the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder with a --- UR
L: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCRes
olutions/MSC.576(110).pdf regulation II-1/3-9.

5.5 In the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder with a trapdo
or in the lower platform, the lower platform shall: .1 have an aperture with dimensions
not less than 750 mm x 750 mm which is open to the ship's hull on the inboard side and w
hich is designed to ensure that the horizontal distance between the pilot ladder and adj
acent edges of the aperture is between 0.1 and 0.2 m; .2 be designed and constructed to:
.1 allow the pilot ladder and manropes to pass through the aperture without obstruction
or distortion; .2 ensure the pilot ladder lies flat against the ship's side; .3 ensure t
hat structural members shall not interfere with or lay against the pilot ladders; and .4
ensure the highest step of the pilot ladder is at least 2 m above the lower platform and
remain compliant with part B; .3 not be provided with fixtures other than the frame refe
rred to in --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOR
esolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf lower platform and remain compliant with part
B; .3 not be provided with fixtures other than the frame referred to in paragraph 5.5.7,
which allows a pilot ladder to be suspended from the lower platform of the accommodation
ladder; .4 have a trapdoor which opens upwards and which is secured flat on the embarkat
ion platform or against a stanchion either at the aft end or outboard side of the platfo
rm, and in any case not obstructing the access to the ship; .5 be provided with sufficie
nt round handholds with a diameter of no less than 28 mm and not more than 32 mm to allo
w safe mounting or dismounting of the pilot ladder.

The structure of the platform itself shall not be relied upon to provide handholds; .6 b
e provided with sufficient handholds with a height of not less than 1.2 m above the plat
form; and .7 where a structural frame is used to comply with paragraph 5.5.2, the follow
ing shall apply: .1 the accommodation ladder platform, frame, pilot ladder connection --
- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MS
CResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf shall apply: .1 the accommodation ladder platform, frame,
pilot ladder connection points, accommodation ladder winch, running gear, pad eyes of ma
nropes and locking arrangements shall be designed to withstand vertical forces of at lea
st 48 kN; .2 the highest step of the pilot ladder is at least 2 m above the platform and
is secured to pad eyes on the inboard side of the frame so that it rests firmly against
the side of the ship; and RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE
STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS - 6 - .3 manropes are secured directly to addi
tional pad eyes 2 m above the platform on the inboard side of the frame.

5.6 On all ships to which section 5 applies, a two -tone visual mark, the upper half bei
ng white and the lower half being red, not less than 4 m in height and 0.5 m in width sh
all be provided in the midship half -length of the ship in the vicinity of the pilot b o

arding position to --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Ind
exofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf provided in the midship half -length
of the ship in the vicinity of the pilot b oarding position to indicate to the user whet
her or not a combination arrangement is to be rigged.

The dividing line between the upper and the lower halves of the pilot line shall be 9 m
below the point of access.

6 Securing arrangements 6.1 All strong points, shackles and securing ropes provided or u
sed in accordance with part A or part B shall have a breaking strength of not less than
48 kN.

Securing ropes shall be tagged or otherwise permanently marked in the same way as provid
ed in paragraph 11.3 and those used to aid in rigging the pilot ladder, shall be at leas
t 3 m in length.

The securing arrangements shall be positioned not less than 915 mm, or, if not possible,
the maximum distance permitted by the width of the deck, from the edge of the deck, exce
pt for the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder.

Strong points and shackles shall --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowl
edgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf a combination arrangeme
nt using an accommodation ladder.

Strong points and shackles shall have breaking strength or equivalent safe working load
limits clearly and permanently marked.

Documentation of the conformance of the strong points, shackles and securing ropes shall
be maintained on board and available for inspection purposes.

6.2 Permanent or removable means of bowsing a pilot ladder or embarkation platform to th
e ship's hull shall not be used to support the weight of the boarding arrangement or pil
ot and shall not be used for any other purpose than to secure the arrangement against th
e ship's side.

Removable means of bowsing a pilot ladder or embarkation platform to the ship's side sha
ll be able to be applied and removed by a single person and shall have a holding force o
f not less than 4 kN when used for the purpose of securin g the lower platform of an acc
ommodation ladder or 3 kN when used for securing the pilot ladder or manropes.5F --- URL
: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCReso
lutions/MSC.576(110).pdf ladder or 3 kN when used for securing the pilot ladder or manro
pes.5F 6.3 There shall be a means of securing a pilot ladder at intermediate lengths whi
ch shall be capable of securing the pilot ladder to strong points described in paragraph
6.1 by gripping each set of side ropes of the pilot ladder.

The means of securing, shall have a breaking strength of not less than 48 kN and be desi
gned to prevent any slippage of the side ropes under the conditions of the ladder and st
ep attachment strength test and unrolling tests described in a standard acceptable to th
e Organization.

When type approving means of securing a pilot ladder at intermediate lengths in accordan
ce with Part F, these tests shall be modified to reflect the attachment of the pilot lad
der using a means of securing the pilot ladder other than using its own attachments.

7 Ships' side openings, doors and platforms 7.1 Ships' side doors used for the transfer
of pilots or other personnel shall not open --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresourc
es/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf 7 Ships' sid
e openings, doors and platforms 7.1 Ships' side doors used for the transfer of pilots or
other personnel shall not open outwards unless located below the freeboard deck.

The side opening shall enable a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage large enough f
or the transfer of pilots and other personnel, with a minimum clearance of 2,200 mm in h
eight and 915 mm in width.

7.2 Ships' side openings without a boarding platform shall be provided with strong point
s which are on the lowest deck of the opening and inboard of the ship's side opening.

Strong points shall also be provided on the deck head and inboard of the ship 's side op
ening if it is intended to rig manropes in the manner provided for in paragraph 15.1.1.3
.

7.3 In any event, boarding platforms deployed from ships' side openings and outboard of
the ship shall not be provided where the distance from the platform to the surface of th
e water --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOReso
lutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf the ship shall not be provided where the distanc

e from the platform to the surface of the water in all seagoing conditions of draught an
d trim associated with the normal operation of the ship RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted
on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS - 7 - is less tha
n 5 m.

Platforms shall be mechanically attached to the ship and be marked with safe working loa
d limits.

Certification of successful testing shall be maintained on board and available for inspe
ction.

7.4 The boarding platform shall extend outboard from the ship's side for a minimum dista
nce of 750 mm, with a longitudinal length of a minimum of 750 mm.

The platform shall be securely guarded by handrails.

8 Access to ship's deck Means shall be provided to ensure safe, convenient and unobstruc
ted passage for pilots and other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship
between the head of the pilot --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowledg
eCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf other personnel embarking
on, or disembarking from, the ship between the head of the pilot ladder, or of any accom
modation ladder, and the ship's deck; such access shall be gained directly by a clean an
d unobstructed platform securely guarded by handrails.

Where such passage is by means of: .1 a gateway in the rails or bulwark, adequate handho
lds with a diameter of not less than 32 mm and not more than 36 mm shall be provided at
the point of embarking on or disembarking from the ship on each side which shall be not
less than 0.7 m and not more than 0.8 m apart in clear width.

Each handhold shall be rigidly secured and locked to the ship's structure at or near its
base and also to the ship at a higher point, and shall extend not less than 1.2 m above
the deck to which it is fitted.

Stanchions or handrails of the gateway shall not be attached to the bulwark ladder to pr
event the bulwark ladder from overturning --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources
/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf attached to th
e bulwark ladder to prevent the bulwark ladder from overturning and shall be positioned
no greater than 0.12 m inboard of the edge of the deck.

A ring or eye with an inner diameter not less than 60 mm at a height of the stanchion ab
ove the deck shall be provided to accommodate manropes; .2 a bulwark ladder, it shall be
securely attached to the ship to prevent overturning.

Two separate handhold stanchions with a diameter of not less than 32 mm and not more tha
n 36 mm shall be fitted at the point of embarking on or disembarking from the ship on ea
ch side which shall be not less than 0.7 m and not more than 0.8 m apart in clear width.

Each stanchion shall be rigidly secured and locked to the ship at or near its base and a
lso at a higher point and shall extend not less than 1.2 m above the top of the bulwarks
.

Stanchions or handrails of the gateway shall not be attached to the bulwark ladder to pr
event the bulwark from overturning and shall be --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localres
ources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf bulwarks
.

Stanchions or handrails of the gateway shall not be attached to the bulwark ladder to pr
event the bulwark from overturning and shall be positioned no greater than 0.12 m inboar
d of the edge of the deck.

A ring or eye with an inner diameter not less than 60 mm at a height of the stanchion ab
ove the deck shall be provided to accommodate manropes; or .3 a shipside opening or door
, adequate handholds with a diameter of not less than 32 mm and not more than 36 mm shal
l be provided at the point of embarking on or disembarking from the ship on each side wh
ich shall be not less than 0.7 m and not more than 0.8 m apart in clear width.

Each handhold shall be rigidly secured and locked to the ship’s structure at or near its
base and also to the ship at a higher point to prevent dislodgement and shall extend not
less than 1.2 m above the entry threshold.

Stanchions or handrails shall be positioned no greater than 0.12 m inboard of the edge o
f the deck.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/
MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf shall be positioned no greater than 0.12 m inboard of th
e edge of the deck.

A ring or eye with an inner diameter not less than 60 mm at a height of the stanchion ab
ove the deck shall be provided to accommodate manropes.

9 Protection from chafing Equipment and arrangements shall be designed and installed so
that it is not possible for a pilot ladder side rope or manrope to make contact with any
part of the ship's hull or associated RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025)
PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS - 8 - fixtures and fittings which
could have the potential to cause sharp bends, chafing, abrasion, pinching or otherwise
degrade their performance.

Where contact is unavoidable, contact points shall be rounded to minimize chafing.

The means of rounding could be a permanent fixture, such as a rounded pipe.

Where it is not possible to round contact points owing to ship design, --- URL: https://
wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MS
C.576(110).pdf such as a rounded pipe.

Where it is not possible to round contact points owing to ship design, removable chafing
pads or other temporary arrangements may be used.

They shall be considered acceptable to the Administration, provided the se arrangements
do not prevent pre-use inspections, are removed after use and stowed in accordance with
section 23.

10 Safe approach of the pilot boat Where rubbing bands or other constructional features
prevent the safe approach of a pilot boat, these shall be cut back to provide at least 6
m of unobstructed ship's side.

Specialized offshore ships less than 90 m or other similar ships less than 90 m for whic
h a 6 m gap in the rubbing bands would not be practicable, as determined by the Administ
ration, may be exempted.

In this case, other appropriate measures shall be taken to ensure that pilots and other
personnel are able to embark and disembark safely.

11 Associated equipment Manropes shall be: --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresource
s/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf able to embar
k and disembark safely.

11 Associated equipment Manropes shall be: .1 not less than 28 mm and not more than 32 m
m in diameter and shall be mildew-resistant manila rope, 7F or other material of equival
ent strength, durability, elongation characteristics and grip; .2 of a single length fre
e from splices and knots; and .3 tagged or otherwise permanently marked by the manufactu
rer with at least the following information: .1 the name of the manufacturer; .2 an equi
pment serial number or other means of unique identification which the manufacturer shall
be able to validate; .3 date of manufacture; and .4 name and details of the approving au
thority.

PART B – RIGGING 12 Pilot ladder In all ships, when it is intended to embark and disemba
rk pilots or other personnel by means of the pilot ladder, the pilot ladder shall be sec
ured to the dedicated strong points meeting the requirements of paragraph 6.1 and positi
oned so that: --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofI
MOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf requirements of paragraph 6.1 and position
ed so that: .1 it is clear of any possible discharge from the ships and at all times han
gs vertically, free and without obstruction; .2 it is within the parallel body length of
the ship and within the midship half-length of the ship; .3 each step rests firmly again
st the ship's side and is horizontal in all planes throughout the entire vertical length
of the ladder; RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS F
OR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS - 9 - .4 when used in conjunction with ships' side openin
gs, the ladder is secured in accordance with section 14; .5 when a retrieval line is con
sidered necessary to ensure the safe rigging of a pilot ladder, the line is secured to t
he forward end, at or above the lowest spreader step and leads forward.

The retrieval line shall not hinder the pilot or other personnel nor obstruct the safe a
pproach of the pilot boat; and --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowled
geCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf or other personnel nor ob
struct the safe approach of the pilot boat; and .6 the lowest step of the pilot ladder,
by using the means specified in paragraph 6.3, is at the height above the surface of the
water requested by the pilot or other personnel being transferred.

13 Combination arrangements 13.1 The combination arrangement shall be so positioned and
secured that: .1 the pilot ladder complies with the requirements in section 12; .2 the a
ccommodation ladder leads aft and is clear of any discharges; .3 the lower platform of t

he accommodation ladder is secured to the ship's side by means of permanent fixtures or removable fixtures within the parallel body length of the ship and within the midship ha lf-length; .4 the lower platform is in a horizontal position when in use and is a minimu m of 5 m above the surface of the water in all seagoing conditions of draught and trim; .5 the pilot ladder and manropes are secured to the ship's side at a point of --- URL: h ttps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolut ions/MSC.576(110).pdf and trim; .5 the pilot ladder and manropes are secured to the ship 's side at a point of nominally 1.5 m above the lower platform of the accommodation ladd er except as outlined in paragraph 5.5.7; .6 the pilot ladder and manropes are not secur ed to the lower platform of the accommodation ladder at any time; and .7 the pilot ladde r is rigged immediately adjacent to the lower platform of the accommodation ladder and t he highest step of the pilot ladder is at least 2 m above the lower platform.

The horizontal distance between the pilot ladder and the lower platform shall be between 0.1 and 0.2 m.

13.2 In the case of a combination arrangement using an accommodation ladder with a trapd oor in the lower platform, the lower platform shall be positioned and rigged in accordan ce with the requirements of paragraphs 5.5 and 13.1.

14 Ships' side openings 14.1 Pilot ladders rigged from ships' side openings without a bo arding platform shall not --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCen tre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf 14 Ships' side openings 14.1 P ilot ladders rigged from ships' side openings without a boarding platform shall not exte nd above the lowest deck of the opening and shall not be rigged from any other position, including the freeboard deck.

14.2 Pilot ladders used in conjunction with ships' side openings with a boarding platfor m complying with paragraph 7.3 shall be rigged aft of such platforms and may be rigged f rom the freeboard deck provided that the ladder and manropes are secured above the p lat form in accordance with paragraphs 13.1.5 and 13.1.7.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF ER ARRANGEMENTS - 10 - 15 Associated equipment 15.1 The following associated equipment s hall be available and ready for immediate use at the point of access whilst the pilot or other personnel are being transferred: .1 two manropes complying with the requirements s tipulated within section 11 which shall: --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/ en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf .1 two manropes complying with the requirements stipulated within section 11 which shall: .1 be free fro m contamination and knots; however, knots used to tie or secure manropes to strong point s are acceptable; .2 when required by pilots or other personnel embarking or disembarkin g, be rigged and secured in accordance with relevant requirements of these performance s tandards; and .3 when rigged, be fixed at the rope end to dedicated strong points on the deck and pass through the ring or eye fitted at the top of the stanchions at the point o f access to the deck.

When the pilot ladder is rigged from a ship side opening, manropes may be rigged from th e deck head, provided that the manropes pass through the ring or the eye at the top of t he stanchions at the point of access; .2 a lifebuoy equipped with a self-igniting light; and .3 a heaving line free from contamination and having a length which can reach --- UR L: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCRes olutions/MSC.576(110).pdf .2 a lifebuoy equipped with a self-igniting light; and .3 a he aving line free from contamination and having a length which can reach the waterline in any seagoing condition of draught or trim.

15.2 When required by section 8 of these performance standards, stanchions and bulwark l adders shall be provided.

PART C – INSTALLATION OF PILOT LADDER WINCH REELS 16 Stowage of pilot ladders on winch r eels If a pilot ladder is to be stowed on a winch drum, the drum diameter shall be not l ess than 0.16 m and the drum shall be provided with sunken securing points.

17 Point of access 17.1 When a pilot ladder winch reel is provided, it shall be situated at a position which will ensure pilots and other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and the point of access to the ship, have safe, convenient and unobstructed access to or egress from the ship.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf pilot ladder and the point of access to the ship, have s afe, convenient and unobstructed access to or egress from the ship.

17.2 The point of access position and adjacent area shall be kept clear of obstructions,

including the pilot ladder winch reel, for distances as follows: .1 915 mm in width meas
ured longitudinally; .2 915 mm in depth, measured from the ship's side plating inwards;
and .3 2,200 mm in height, measured vertically from the access deck.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF
ER ARRANGEMENTS - 11 - 18 Physical positioning of pilot ladder winch reels 18.1 Pilot la
dder winch reels which are fitted on a ship's upper deck for the purpose of providing a
pilot ladder which services a ship's side opening below the upper deck or, alternatively
, an accommodation ladder when a combination arrangement is provided shall: --- URL: htt
ps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutio
ns/MSC.576(110).pdf alternatively, an accommodation ladder when a combination arrangemen
t is provided shall: .1 be situated at a location on the upper deck from which the pilot
ladder is able to be suspended vertically, in a straight line, to a point adjacent to th
e ship's side opening access point or the lower platform of the accommodation ladder; .2
be situated at a location which provides a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage for
pilots or other personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot
ladder and the place of access on the ship; and .3 enable compliance with the relevant r
equirements of part A and part B.

18.2 Pilot ladder winch reels fitted inside a ship's side opening shall: .1 be situated
at a position which provides a safe, convenient and unobstructed passage for pilots or o
ther personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and
the place of access on the ship; --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowl
edgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf passage for pilots or o
ther personnel embarking on, or disembarking from, the ship between the pilot ladder and
the place of access on the ship; .2 be situated at a position which provides an unobstru
cted clear area with a minimum length of 915 mm and minimum width of 915 mm and minimum
vertical height of 2,200 mm; and .3 if situated at a position which necessitates a secti
on of the pilot ladder to be partially secured in a horizontal position on the deck so a
s to provide a clear access as described above, then allowance shall be made so that thi
s section of the pilot ladder may be covered with a rigid platform for a minimum distanc
e of 915 mm measured horizontally from the ship's side inwards.

19 Handrails and handgrips Handrails and handgrips shall be provided in accordance with
section 8 to assist the pilot and other personnel to safely transfer between the pilot l
adder and the ship, except as noted in --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en
/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf other personnel t
o safely transfer between the pilot ladder and the ship, except as noted in paragraph 7.
4 for arrangements with platforms extending outboard.

Th e horizontal distance between the handrails and/or the handgrips shall be not less th
an 0.7 m or more than 0.8 m apart.

20 Securing of the pilot ladder Where the pilot ladder is stowed on a pilot ladder winch
reel which is located either within the ship's side opening or on the upper deck: .1 the
pilot ladder winch reel shall not be relied upon to support the pilot ladder when the pi
lot ladder is in use; .2 the pilot ladder shall be secured to strong points, independent
of the pilot ladder winch reel; and RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PE
RFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSFER ARRANGEMENTS - 12 - .3 the pilot ladder shall be
secured at deck level inside the ship's side opening or, when located on the ship's uppe
r deck, at a distance of not less --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Know
ledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf or, when located on th
e ship's upper deck, at a distance of not less than 915 mm measured horizontally from th
e ship's side inwards.

21 Mechanical securing of pilot ladder winch reel 21.1 All pilot ladder winch reels shal
l have means of preventing the winch reel from being accidentally operated as a result o
f mechanical failure or human error.

21.2 Pilot ladder winch reels may be manually operated or, alternatively, powered by eit
her electrical, hydraulic or pneumatic means.

21.3 Manually operated pilot ladder winch reels shall be provided with a brake or other
suitable arrangements to control the lowering of the pilot ladder and to lock the winch
reel in position once the pilot ladder is lowered into position.

21.4 Electrical, hydraulic or pneumatically driven pilot ladder winch reels shall be fit
ted with safety devices which are capable of cutting off the power supply to the winch r
eel and thus locking the winch reel in position.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/

MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf safety devices which are capable of cutting off the powe
r supply to the winch reel and thus locking the winch reel in position.

21.5 Powered winch reels shall have clearly marked control levers or handles which may b
e locked in a neutral position.

21.6 A mechanical device or locking pin shall also be utilized to lock powered winch ree
ls.

PART D – OPERATIONAL READINESS, ONBOARD INSPECTION AND MAINTENANCE 22 Periodic maintenan
ce and inspections shall be carried out to ensure the pilot transfer arrangements are in
good condition, free from contamination and ready for use.

Regardless of the date of installation, maintenance and inspection of accommodation ladd
ers used in the combination arrangement shall be carried out in accordance with SOLAS re
gulation II-1/3-9.3.

23 Pilot ladders, manropes and all associated equipment, when not in use, shall be stowe
d to prevent degradation caused by moisture, icing and sunlight, chemicals and greases -
-- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/M
SCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf stowed to prevent degradation caused by moisture, icing a
nd sunlight, chemicals and greases and similar contaminants, and in accordance with the
manufacturer's instructions.

24 Instructions for care, maintenance, inspection and stowage shall be supplied with eac
h pilot ladder, manropes and all associated equipment.

These instructions shall include: .1 pre- and post-use inspection instructions; .2 detai
led periodic inspection procedures, including those for side ropes; .3 instructions for
inspecting and repairing rope seizings or securing devices, along with a list of permitt
ed onboard repairs; .4 care and stowage instructions, including warnings about chemical
exposure, sunlight impact and other potential causes of ladder degradation; .5 factors a
ffecting pilot ladder life, including stowage arrangements; .6 acceptable method(s) of s
ecuring ladder to strong points; .7 pictorial examples and detailed written description
of damage or conditions --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentr
e/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf .6 acceptable method(s) of secur
ing ladder to strong points; .7 pictorial examples and detailed written description of d
amage or conditions warranting withdrawing the ladder from service; and .8 care and main
tenance specifics for natural fibre rope ladders.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF
ER ARRANGEMENTS - 13 - 25 Pilot transfer arrangements shall be subject to: .1 inspection
before and after each use by a responsible officer on board; and .2 a detailed inspectio
n every three months by a responsible officer on board.

26 In order to determine the suitability for ongoing use of the pilot transfer arrangeme
nts, inspections shall include the following: .1 the pilot ladder including spares; .2 t
he accommodation ladder used in a combination arrangement; .3 winch reels; .4 securing a
rrangements; .5 conditions of point of access; --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localreso
urces/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf .3 winch
reels; .4 securing arrangements; .5 conditions of point of access; .6 relevant equipment
, in particular stanchions and stanchion sockets welded onto the deck; and .7 stowage ar
rangements.

27 A maintenance plan shall be developed and shall be available for inspection.

The maintenance plan shall be easily understood, illustrated as appropriate wherever pos
sible, and shall include the following: .1 a checklist for use when carrying out the ins
pections required by section 25; .2 maintenance, repair and stowage instructions, in acc
ordance with manufacturer's instructions; .3 schedule of periodic inspection and mainten
ance; .4 list of sources of spare parts or replacements; .5 log for records of inspectio
ns and maintenance; and .6 record of when the pilot ladder or manropes were brought into
service and their anticipated date of withdrawal from service in accordance with section
30 of these performance standards.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/
MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf their anticipated date of withdrawal from service in acc
ordance with section 30 of these performance standards.

28 Repair or replacement of pilot ladder steps or spreader steps shall be prohibited.

29 At least one spare compliant pilot ladder and one spare set of compliant manropes sha
ll be carried on board the ship.

30 Pilot ladders and manropes, including their spares, shall be removed from service, ei
ther at any time not complying with these performance standards, or within 36 months aft
er the date of manufacture or within 30 months after the date of being placed into servi
ce, whichever comes first, and shall not be used for the embarkation and disembarkation
of pilots or other personnel.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF
ER ARRANGEMENTS - 14 - PART E – FAMILIARIZATION 31 Onboard personnel involved in the ins
pection, maintenance, rigging or operation of --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresou
rces/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf - 14 - PAR
T E – FAMILIARIZATION 31 Onboard personnel involved in the inspection, maintenance, rigg
ing or operation of any equipment for pilot transfer arrangements shall receive familiar
ization to perform their assigned duties.

This shall form part of the onboard familiarization of the crew.

32 On ships to which SOLAS chapter IX applies, the company, as defined in SOLAS regulati
on IX/1.2, ensures that onboard personnel involved in the operation of inspection, maint
enance, rigging or operation of any equipment for pilot transfer arrangements are famili
arized with the onboard pilot transfer arrangements for safe operation in accordance wit
h STCW regulation I/14.

33 On ships to which SOLAS chapter IX does not apply, familiarization on board shall inc
lude, but not be limited to: .1 operation and use of the equipment and arrangements for
the transfer of pilots and other personnel provided on board the ship; --- URL: https://
wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MS
C.576(110).pdf .1 operation and use of the equipment and arrangements for the transfer o
f pilots and other personnel provided on board the ship; .2 the characteristics of pilot
transfer arrangements which shall not be used for the transfer of pilots or other person
nel; .3 carrying out inspections and maintenance of the pilot transfer arrangements, inc
luding spare ladders on board; .4 replacement procedures of pilot ladders and manropes;
and .5 when applicable, measures and additional equipment or operational considerations
to be made to ensure the integrity of the pilot ladder in special conditions, i.e.

freezing or windy condition or rough weather especially when there is moderate swell.

PART F – APPROVAL 34 Pilot transfer arrangements installed in accordance with SOLAS regu
lation V/23.3 shall be approved by the Administration in accordance with these performan
ce standards before being put into service for the first time and after repair, alterati
on or modification to the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCen
tre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf before being put into service
for the first time and after repair, alteration or modification to the arrangements prov
ided for in sections 5 to 8 and section 10 of part A, or part C, of these performance st
andards.

35 Pilot transfer arrangements installed in accordance with SOLAS regulations V/23.4 and
23.5 shall be approved by the Administration in accordance with these performance standa
rds after alteration or modification, if any, or repair, to the arrangements provided fo
r in sections 5 to 8 and section 10 of part A, or part C, of these performance standards
.

36 A pilot ladder, including the means of securing the pilot ladder at intermediate leng
ths, and manropes shall be type -approved by the Administration in accordance with these
performance standards.

37 A manufacturer quality control system shall be required and shall be audited by a com
petent authority to ensure continuous compliance with the type approval conditions.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/
MSCResolutions/MSC.576(110).pdf competent authority to ensure continuous compliance with
the type approval conditions.

Alternatively, the Administration may use final product verification procedures where co
mpliance with the type approval certificate is verified by a competent authority before
the product is installed on board ships.

RESOLUTION MSC.576(110) (adopted on 26 June 2025) PERFORMANCE STANDARDS FOR PILOT TRANSF
ER ARRANGEMENTS --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Indexo
fIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.580(110).pdf RESOLUTION MSC.580(110) (adopted on 27 J
une 2025) AMENDMENTS TO THE REVISED RECOMMENDATION ON TESTING OF LIFE-SAVING APPLIANCES
(RESOLUTION MSC.81(70)) MSC 110/21/Add.3 Annex 19, page 1 I:\MSC\110\MSC 110-21-Add.3.do
cx ANNEX 19 RESOLUTION MSC.

580(110) (adopted on 27 June 2025) AMENDMENTS TO THE REVISED RECOMMENDATION ON TESTING O F LIFE-SAVING APPLIANCES (RESOLUTION MSC.81(70)) THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE, RECALLIN G Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO that the Assembly, when adopting resoluti on A.689(17) on Testing of life-saving appliances, authorized the Committee to keep the annexed Recommendation on testing of life -saving applianc